33번

From around 3000 BC, the Sumerian officials would mark their lists of goods on clay tablets.

If they wanted to record five fish, they would mark five pictures of a fish.

Their first great intellectual leap came from separating the number from the object they were counting.

In other words, they would represent five fish with a numeral for the number five alongside a symbol for the fish.

If they wanted to describe five of something else, they realized they could keep the same numeral and trade the object symbol for a cow, or a jar of oil, or whatever else they were interested in.

The Sumerians had developed the idea of an emancipated number, existing in its own right and independent of whatever it is being used to count.

It is easy to take the emancipated number for granted as it is so deeply set into modern thought, but to the earliest civilizations it was intellectually new and extremely powerful.

34번

The emphasis on learning from the ingroup takes little account of individuals.

Amazingly, while we may dislike some of the people in our ingroup, we still copy them.

Wilks, Kirby, and Nielsen studied copying behavior in the context of observing how to open a puzzle box.

Ingroups and outgroups were distinguished in a minimal way, using simple color coding of wristbands.

The children did not simply like all members of their ingroup; they disliked those who behaved in an antisocial fashion.

Indeed, they liked these antisocial ingroup members less than the prosocial members of an outgroup.

Still, their dislike did not affect their tendency to copy ingroup behavior more closely than outgroup behavior.

This overimitation reveals that we are not copying in order to learn how to open a box most efficiently.

We want to learn how to do it in the proper way — in other words, conforming to the rules and conventions of the ingroup.

This will be appropriately demonstrated even by antisocial ingroup members.

36번

Initially the catchphrase "less is more" had a simple meaning.

First mentioned in Robert Browning's poem "Andrea del Sarto," it suggests that everything simple is better and more beautiful than the complex and tangled.

Nowadays this phrase is heard often — maybe even too often.

But it's important to recognize that the way of thinking that lies behind these words slowly extinguishes certain habits from our daily life.

For example, think about the heavy, massive radio receivers that existed back in the day.

Over time, many of their buttons became viewed as "extra" and were removed, and with each reduction these devices eventually developed into the phones in our pockets.

The scale of the object became smaller, and the functions of the buttons got lost in the three-dot menus and multilayered folders of our phones.

38번

As Kuhn proposed, our propositions about the world are embedded within paradigms, roughly a network of interrelated commitments to a particular theory, a conception of a subject matter, and methodological practices.

Thus, when scientists undertake research, they do so from within a specific paradigm.

Even the most exacting measurements are only sensible from within that paradigm.

For example, a look into a microscope tells you nothing unless you are already informed about the nature of the instrument and what you are supposed to be looking at.

Thus, what we call major progress in science is not a movement from a less to a more accurate paradigm.

Rather, it is a horizontal shift from one 'way of seeing the world' to another.

For Kuhn, 'the scientist with a new paradigm sees differently from the way he had seen before.'